

Population 588,254?

The NSO's World Population Day release, tested against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

“The estimated total population of Malta and Gozo stood at 588,254 at the end of 2025.”

National Statistics Office, News Release NR 120/2026, 9 July 2026

Up 2.4% on the previous year; net migration of 13,906 the main contributor.

We recomputed every figure in the claim from Eurostat's demographic accounts.

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

*Every figure reproduces
from the Eurostat data.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

588,254

Residents, end 2025

Eurostat's 1 January 2026 population matches the NSO's figure exactly.

+2.4%

Growth over 2025

588,254 against 574,250 is +2.44%.

13,906

Net migration, 2025

Up 31.0% on 2024 (10,614). Matches Eurostat.

99.3%

Growth from migration

Births minus deaths added only 98 people (193 in 2024).

98 + 13,906

= the 14,004 increase

The components add up to the change in the population, with nothing left over.

FAIR TO SAY

Eurostat's data for Malta come from the NSO, so this confirms consistency, not an independent count.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ NSO: the revision policy for end-year estimates.

☐ NSO: the method for counting net migration.

☐ Readers: cite the NSO release, not a headline.

☐ Anyone quoting a national density: give the area used.